

# *Healthy Family, Healthy Community*

The Helti Famili checklist shows 16 things a healthy family has. Use it with each family on home visits, and help them choose what to improve first.

**For health workers**

## *Key messages*

- Sit with the family and go through the 16 items below. Mark each one: Red if the family has none, Yellow if they have some but not enough, Green if they have enough.
- Look at the yellow and red items together. Ask what makes each one hard, and what small step the family can take first.
- Ask the person to say their commitment out loud, ideally in front of family. Check progress on your next visit.

- Visit families with new mothers and babies, sick people, and children not growing well first.
- Visits last about 30 minutes. Invite husbands, parents and older children to join. Do the conversation first, then care.
- Bring the household monitoring form and the Mother and Child Health Record Books.
- Keep everything you learn in the household private.

## ***Helti Famili checklist***

*Tick one box for each: none, some or enough.*

|                                  | None | Some | Enough |
|----------------------------------|------|------|--------|
| 1. Clean house                   |      |      |        |
| 2. Clean water                   |      |      |        |
| 3. Toilet                        |      |      |        |
| 4. Rubbish pit                   |      |      |        |
| 5. Foods that help the body grow |      |      |        |

|                                                 | None | Some | Enough |
|-------------------------------------------------|------|------|--------|
| 6. Many kinds of fruit and vegetables           |      |      |        |
| 7. Foods that give strength                     |      |      |        |
| 8. Small garden near the house                  |      |      |        |
| 9. Children and women are vaccinated            |      |      |        |
| 10. Beds to sleep on                            |      |      |        |
| 11. Plates, spoons, cups and saucepans          |      |      |        |
| 12. Lamp                                        |      |      |        |
| 13. Mosquito net, clothes, blankets and pillows |      |      |        |
| 14. Spade, axe and bush knife                   |      |      |        |
| 15. A way to earn money                         |      |      |        |
| 16. Peace and good living together              |      |      |        |

## ***Tell the health facility if you see***

- A child who is very thin, has swollen feet, or is not growing
- Many people in one village with the same sickness
- A household with no safe drinking water
- A pregnant woman who has not been to antenatal care

## ***Run a village session***

1. Meet in a shaded, central place at a time when families can come. Greet everyone and say what today's topic is.
2. Ask what people already know and what they have heard. Listen first.
3. Share three key messages from this page in your local language. Use pictures and real examples from the village.
4. Ask people to say the messages back in their own words, and answer questions.
5. Agree on one action the village will take this month. Refer anyone who is unwell, and record who came.

*General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines. Based on the National Department of Health Village Health Assistant (VHA) training curriculum.*